

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 22

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 5 reminds us that when we attack and cruelly suppress our True Self we create destructive consequences; we end up losing our true life. What would our lives be like if we accepted and cared for ourselves as God accepts and cares for us?

Let's look at the description of God's character in **Psalms 103**. Nancy has expanded the meaning of this psalm by contrasting the demands and unmerciful retribution of the Idol Self with the kind intention and mercy of God. This psalm is a little long, so relax and consider just one or two ideas that resonate with you.

A psalm of David in praise of the Lord's mercies:

¹Tell of the goodness of the Lord, my True Self,
And all that is within me, reveal His exceptional character.

²Tell of the goodness of the Lord, my True Self,
And forget none of His benefits (especially when I am experiencing self-hate);

³The Lord, who pardons all of my iniquities (even when I can't forgive myself),
The Lord, who heals all of my diseases (even when I can't figure out how to stop being neurotic),

⁴The Lord, who redeems my life from the pit (even when I've dug that pit for myself),
The Lord, who endows me with lovingkindness and compassion (even when I can't experience it),

⁵Who satisfies my desires with good things (even when I can't recognize what is good).
His goal is to renew my original, created design so that I can soar like an eagle rising on its wings.

⁶The Lord performs oriented deeds (and hopes that I will do the same),
And He gives justice to all who are oppressed (by the Idol's legal systems, pride, and self-hate).

⁷He revealed His good and beneficial support to Moses, His ability to guide and to help the sons of Israel.

⁸The Lord is compassionate and gracious (unlike the Idol, which is vindictive and demanding).

The Lord is slow to anger and abounding in lovingkindness (unlike the Idol Self, which is reactive and abounds in egocentric compulsive needs).

⁹The Lord will not always strive with our Idol Self,

Nor will He keep His anger forever (unlike the Idol, which must reserve a store of wrath and keep accounts of wrongs suffered).

¹⁰The Lord has not dealt with us according to our misorientation (unlike the Idol, which deals with us severely when we don't perform to its standards).

Nor has the Lord rewarded us according to our iniquities (unlike the Idol, which rewards us with self-hate when we fail to live up to its pride system).

¹¹For as high as the heavens are above the earth,

So great is the Lord's lovingkindness toward those who fear Him (who are more responsive to Him than to their Idol Self).

¹²As far as the east is from the west,

So far has the Lord removed our transgressions from us (unlike the Idol, which keeps those past failures ever-present and full of shame).

¹³Just as a father has compassion on his children,

So the Lord has compassion on those who fear Him, (for those who want to do things His way).

¹⁴For He Himself knows our frame and its limitations;

He is mindful that we are only dust (whereas our Idol is only mindful that we should be God).

¹⁵As with all creatures, our days are like grass;

As a flower of the field, we flourish

¹⁶But when the wind has passed over it, it is no more,

And its place acknowledges it no longer, (but the Idol is screaming, "Wait! What about the *Glory of Me*? I am forever!")

¹⁷Though we are just dust, the lovingkindness of the Lord is from everlasting to everlasting toward those who fear Him,

And His orientation is passed from His children to their children,

¹⁸To those who are trustworthy and keep His covenant,

And all that is within me, reveal His exceptional character.

Who remember His do's and don'ts and are guided by them.

Take a deep breath.

In this last part of this psalm, we are reminded of our creatureliness and vulnerability and, also, of the lovingkindness of the Lord, which never changes toward those who fear Him. The Lord wants to be on our side. He wants to support us in our true development, but as long as we are serving the interests of the Idol, He is forced to compassionately oppose us and wait.

In this material world that is passing away, it is so easy to forget that we are fundamentally eternal beings, the children of a heavenly Father. We were created for happiness. That means that we can experience happiness at any moment in time, as well as in eternity.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Help me see things like You do, Father. Help me see myself like You do. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time of healing and training together. Help us explore our eternal nature as You guide us to our glory and to the truth about who we are. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our own lives for a more effective flow, and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and all of its limitations, with the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.